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 Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research, Mumbai, India.

## Education

**Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research**

Mumbai, India

PhD in Development Studies

2021 – Present

**Thesis Title:** Mergers, Efficiency, and Market Power:  
Three Essays In Banking And Finance.

Supervisors: [Prof. Subrata Sarkar](#) and [Prof. A. Ganesh Kumar](#)

Committee Member: [Prof. K V Ramaswamy](#)

Status: Thesis submitted (under examination)

**Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research**

Mumbai, India

M.S. Economics

2018 – 2020

Major: Econometrics, Minor: Macroeconomics

CGPA: 3.28/4 .

**Scottish Church College, University of Calcutta**

Kolkata, India

B.Sc. Hons (Economics)

2015 – 2018

Minor : Mathematics, Statistics.

## Research interests

My primary research interest lies in the area of banking & corporate finance, applied microeconomics, applied industrial organisation and causal inference. I also share a broader interest in macro-finance and monetary policy.

## Working papers

**"Impact of Mergers and Acquisitions on the Efficiency of the Indian Banking System"**

(under-review)

*Summary:* This paper examines the impact of one of the largest state-led public sector bank consolidations on the efficiency of Indian banks. It uses a bias-corrected bootstrapped data envelopment analysis and a staggered difference-in-differences estimation to provide the first causal evidence on how large-scale state-led mergers shape bank efficiency in an emerging market. The findings show despite negative market reactions to merger announcements, both input and output efficiency improve post-consolidation.

**"Profit Efficiency, Mergers and Bank Risk: A Study on Indian Banks."**

(Job Market Paper)

*Summary:* This paper estimates efficiency scores when risk is explicitly incorporated into its measurement, using the Indian banking data from 2005–2024. It also analyses how bank consolidation affected the risk-incorporated efficiency measure using a bayesian stochastic frontier approach and a staggered difference-in-differences design. The findings show that conventional efficiency measures overstate bank performance by ignoring risk. In the post-consolidation period, risk-adjusted efficiency declines more persistently and adversely than standard metrics suggest, implying that mergers amplify underlying risk exposures. Hence, the paper highlights integration of risk in efficiency measurement is very crucial specifically in the light of major structural changes.

## "Bank Mergers and Market Power: Evidence from India."

*Summary:* This paper investigates the impact of recent bank mergers on the market power of the Indian banks from 2005–2024. Using a stochastic frontier framework, it estimates credit and investment markups alongside the Lerner Index, and track concentration through Herfindahl–Hirschman Indices. The results show a 20-29 percentage point increase in the market power of merged banks and a 5.9 percentage point rise for private banks. Hence, it implies that in Indian banking sphere the competition is reducing and the public banks are enjoying more market power in the post-consolidation environment.

|                            |                                                                                                                                                              |                                       |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Teaching experience        | <b>Teaching Assistant</b>                                                                                                                                    | IGIDR, Mumbai                         |
|                            | Supervisor: Dr. Shubhro Sarkar<br>Course: Microeconomics I and Game Theory                                                                                   | 2022 – 2025                           |
|                            | <b>Teaching Assistant</b>                                                                                                                                    | IGIDR, Mumbai                         |
|                            | Supervisor: Dr. Shubhro Sarkar<br>Course: Microeconomics I                                                                                                   | 2021                                  |
| Research / Work experience | <b>Research Assistant</b>                                                                                                                                    | IGIDR, Mumbai                         |
|                            | Supervisor: Prof. Rupayan Pal<br>Course: Oligopoly Theory                                                                                                    | January 2022 – June 2022              |
|                            | <b>Research Assistant</b>                                                                                                                                    | IGIDR, Mumbai                         |
|                            | Supervisor: Dr. Bharti Nandwani<br>Course: Political Economy                                                                                                 | January 2021 – August 2021            |
|                            | <b>Research Intern</b>                                                                                                                                       | StartupManch, Hyderabad               |
|                            | Worked Under: Pratyush Malviya<br>Project: Critical evaluation of government schemes and policies aiding startups and MSMEs in India                         | August 2020 – October 2020            |
|                            | <b>Summer Intern</b>                                                                                                                                         | Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata |
|                            | Supervisor: Dr. Priyodorshi Banerjee<br>Project: Assessing individual degree of risk aversion through experimental interface design using the software Ztree | May 2019 – July 2019                  |
| Conferences & Workshops    | <b>Research Scholars' Day</b>                                                                                                                                |                                       |
|                            | Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur                                                                                                                       | 2024                                  |
|                            | <b>Fifth Annual Economics Conference</b>                                                                                                                     |                                       |
|                            | Ahmedabad University                                                                                                                                         | 2024                                  |
|                            | <b>Fourth Annual Economics and Finance Conference</b>                                                                                                        |                                       |
|                            | BITS Pilani, Hyderabad                                                                                                                                       | 2023                                  |
|                            | <b>Flair 4 Big Data Summer School</b>                                                                                                                        |                                       |
|                            | IGIDR, Mumbai                                                                                                                                                | 2022                                  |
|                            | <b>Geo-statistical Methods for Economic Analysis Workshop</b>                                                                                                |                                       |
|                            | IGIDR, Mumbai                                                                                                                                                | 2022                                  |
|                            | <b>Eleventh INSEE-IIITD International Conference</b>                                                                                                         |                                       |
|                            | Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology, New Delhi                                                                                                  | 2021                                  |
|                            | <b>Confluence Annual Economic Summit</b>                                                                                                                     |                                       |
|                            | St. Xaviers College, Kolkata                                                                                                                                 | 2017, 2016                            |
| Honors and scholarships    | <b>NSE Best Paper Award</b>                                                                                                                                  |                                       |
|                            | Amrut Mody School of Management, Ahmedabad University                                                                                                        | 2024                                  |
|                            | <b>PhD Research Fellowship (IGIDR, Mumbai)</b>                                                                                                               | since 2021                            |
|                            | <b>Second Place Award</b>                                                                                                                                    |                                       |
|                            | Exposition Paper Presentation Competition, St. Xaviers College                                                                                               | 2017, 2016                            |

## Skills

### Programming

Proficient in: R Studio, Stata, MS Excel, EViews,  $\text{\LaTeX}$ .

Familiar with: Python, Matlab/Dynare.

### Relevant Coursework

Econometrics I&II, Time Series Analysis I&II, Applied Econometrics, Microeconomics I&II, Macroeconomics I&II, Monetary Theory and Policy.

### Languages

English, Hindi, Bengali (native)

## References

### Prof. Subrata Sarkar

Professor

IGIDR, Mumbai

[ssarkar.igidr@gmail.com](mailto:ssarkar.igidr@gmail.com)

[ssarkar@igidr.ac.in](mailto:ssarkar@igidr.ac.in)

### Prof. A. Ganesh Kumar

Professor

IGIDR, Mumbai

[agk@igidr.ac.in](mailto:agk@igidr.ac.in)